2. Para aprofundar a relação entre Causa Final e Ação Moral/Humana (Seção 3 ou 4)

- **Ensaio:** Neo-Scholastic Essays (especialmente o cap. 16: *"In Defense of the Perverted Faculty Argument"*)
- **Como usar:** Aqui Feser mostra o **realismo da finalidade aplicado às faculdades naturais**. Ele argumenta que o princípio da finalidade não governa apenas a matéria inanimada, mas que as faculdades biológicas e humanas têm fins intrínsecos objetivos — e que violar esses fins é metafisicamente incoerente. Dá um ótimo peso filosófico ao mostrar o impacto prático do realismo da causa final.

3. Para ancorar o Realismo na Tradição Aristotélica Clássica (Seção 4)

- **Obra/Coletânea:** Aristotle on Method and Metaphysics
- **Como usar:** Utilize para demonstrar como a releitura de Feser se apoia rigorosamente no método aristotélico original, mostrando que a teleologia não é uma "invenção teológica medieval", mas a descoberta lógica primária da ontologia aristotélica sobre a natureza do ser e da mudança.

Introdução (~1/2 Página)

- Objetivo: Contextualizar a crise da teleologia na modernidade e apresentar a tese do artigo.
- Pontos a desenvolver:
  O "desencantamento da natureza" com a revolução científica e a filosofia cartesiana (a redução do mundo à res extensa e a banimento das causas formais e finais).
- Apresentação do projeto filosófico de Edward Feser: o resgate da metafísica aristotélico-tomista na filosofia analítica contemporânea.
- Tese do Paper: O princípio de finalidade em Feser não é um mero recurso heurístico ou mental, mas uma dimensão ontológica do realismo metafísico — sem o qual nem mesmo a causalidade eficiente ou a ciência moderna se sustentam.

2. O Problema Moderno: O Rejeito Mecanicista da Causa Final (~1,5 Página)

- Objetivo: Explicar o paradigma moderno que Feser combate para justificar a necessidade do realismo da finalidade.
- Pontos a desenvolver:

- A visão mecanicista (Descartes, Locke, Hume) e o reducionismo materialista: o mundo visto como mero aglomerado de matéria sem direcionamento intrínseco.
- O Nominalismo e o Antirealismo: a ideia de que a "finalidade" é apenas uma atribuição subjetiva da mente humana (antropomorfismo ou projeção).

- Livro para citar:
  - Aristotle's Revenge: The Metaphysical Foundations of Physical and Biological Science (Capítulo 1 e 2: Crítica ao mecanicismo e ao reducionismo).

" some philosophers and scientists deny that there is any reality other than material reality, and any method of studying reality other than science. That is to say, they defend materialism and scientism. But materialism and scientism are themselves metaphysical positions in the relevant sense. They too address the question whether reality extends beyond the natural world studied by empirical science, and simply answer in the negative." P. 4

"For another, the "mechanistic" philosophy of nature that is the chief rival to Aristotelianism cannot be understood except by contrast with the latter." – p. 13

p 42:

- "It is in living things that the reality of intrinsic teleology and substantial form is most evident."
- "Hence it is not surprising that the Aristotelian might seem committed to a kind of "organic world picture," even if that is a very misleading way of putting things. In any event, early modern critics of the Aristotelian philosophy of nature thought of themselves as replacing an "organic" conception of the world with what has been called a "mechanical philosophy," a "mechanistic" conception of nature, or a "mechanization" of the world. That is to say, they took the notion of the machine rather than that of the organism to be the best model for nature in general. (Cf. Dear 2006, pp. 15-16)"
- "The me- chanical conception was rather a philosophical account of how best to carry out scientific investigation and/or to interpret its results. It is a methodological-cum-metaphysical theory about science, rather than strictly a part of science. That is to say, it is essentially a philosophy of science and a philosophy of nature. That it happens to be a philosophy of science and a philosophy of nature explicitly or at least implicitly ac- cepted by most modern scientists themselves should not blind us to that fact."

p. 43

- "What exactly is the content of the mechanical world picture? What pre- cisely does it mean to say that nature ought to be modeled on a machine? Part of the idea, of course, is that "if you [want] to understand how some- thing work[s], you should try to take it apart and see how it runs," and in particular that "finding out the causal connection between the parts would reveal a lot about how the thing as a whole work[s]" (Churchland 1995, p. 24)."
- "The correct way to understand how the mechanical world pic- ture differs from Aristotelianism is to recall the Aristotelian distinction between natural objects and human artifacts, or more precisely between, on the one hand, things having substantial forms and intrinsic teleology and, on the other, things having merely accidental forms and at most merely extrinsic teleology. A true natural substance is one having a sub- stantial form and intrinsic teleology (as the liana vine of my earlier exam- ple does). Artifacts (including machines) and other objects with merely accidental forms and thus at most only extrinsic teleology (as in the case of the hammock) or no teleology at all (as in the case of a random pile of stones) are secondary kinds of reality, parasitic on the existence of natu- ral substances. To be part of the "natural" order of things just is to have a substantial form and intrinsic teleology; and thus, to lack substantial (p 44) form and intrinsic teleology just is not to be "natural" in this sense. What- ever else we say about nature, then, it is for the Aristotelian precisely not a machine or any other kind of artifact, despite the superficial similarities (such as the fact that both machines and natural substances have inter- acting parts)."

p. 44

- "The "mechanical world picture" is essentially a rejection of this fundamental conception of what is "natural," and of everything implicit in it."
- "There is also an emphasis on those as-pects of nature which are predictable and controllable in the way the behav-ior of a machine (ideally) is. This entails a focus on the quantifiable aspects of nature (which are more susceptible of strict prediction and control), and thus on a mathematical description of physical systems as paradig-matic of scientific rigor."
- "Matter is, to a first approximation, conceived of in terms of funda-mental particles possessing only such "primary qualities" as size, shape, spatial position, and local motion, and devoid of "secondary qualities" like color, sound, odor, taste, heat, and cold, which are reinterpreted as mere projections of the mind rather than really inhering in material things as they are in themselves.
- "For Descartes' plenum version of the mechanical picture, matter is pure extension in space, so that it is infinitely divisible (since whatever is extended can be divided into ever smaller units) and there is no void space through which bits of matter pass (since such purportedly empty space would itself be extended and thus filled with matter)."

p.47

- For thinkers like Descartes and Newton, while there is no teleology intrinsic to material things, there is certainly teleology extrinsic to them. For Descartes, purposes exist in the thoughts and volitions of the immaterial soul or res cogitans, and these purposes are reflected in speech,

bodily behavior, and the things we make, even if the sounds we make, the motions of our limbs, and the objects we create would have no purposes apart from those thoughts and volitions. Descartes and Newton also took final cause to exist in God, who imparts purposes to the material world that it wouldn't otherwise have.

P. 49

- Accordingly, the abandonment of teleology dissolved this cement, making causes and effects inherently "loose and separate," as Hume famously put it. In principle, any effect or none could follow upon any cause. Why, then, do we observe causal regularities in the world rather than the randomness that the abandonment of teleology would imply? The answer of the early proponents of the mechanical philosophy was that if nothing intrinsic to things could account for this regularity, something extrinsic to them still could, namely laws of nature. The notion of a law of nature was understood by thinkers like Descartes and Newton in explicitly theological terms, as a divine decree that things will behave in such-and-such a way.

p. 50

- Those inspired by Hume have tended to regard laws as mere regularities. The idea here is that to say, for example, that it is a law of nature that events of type A are followed by events of type B is simply to assert that in fact events of type A are always followed by events of type B. It is merely to note that that is the way the world happens to work.
-

    - The Last Superstition: A Refutation of the New Atheism (Capítulo 2: A mudança de paradigma da Antiguidade/Medieval para a Modernidade).

3. O Princípio de Finalidade e a Causalidade Eficiente (~1,5 Página)

- Objetivo: Construir o argumento ontológico de que toda causa eficiente exige uma causa final real.
- Pontos a desenvolver:

  A definição do Princípio da Finalidade: omne agens agit propter finem ("toda causa age por um fim").

  O argumento do direcionamento: Se A gera regularmente B (e não C ou nada), existe uma tendência regular/direcionada de A para B. Essa tendência é a causa final.

  Se a finalidade não fosse real nas coisas, a relação causal eficiente seria inteiramente indeterminada (o problema das regularidades naturais).

  A diferença entre a teleologia extrínseca (artefatos/máquinas) e a teleologia intrínseca (substâncias naturais).
- Livro para citar:

Scholastic Metaphysics: A Contemporary Introduction (Capítulo 2, Seção 2.4: Final Causality — onde ele demonstra detalhadamente a necessidade da causa final para sustentar a causa eficiente).

4. A Ordem do Realismo Metafísico: Essência, Forma e Teleologia (~1,5 Página)

- Objetivo: Conectar o princípio da finalidade com o realismo das formas e essências (Hilomorfismo).
- Pontos a desenvolver:
  Realismo Escolástico/Moderado: As essências e formas substanciais não são meros nomes (nominalismo), mas reais na matéria.

  Como a causa formal determina a causa final: A natureza (physis) de uma substância determina seus fins e potências de atualização.

  Ato e Potência: A finalidade como o direcionamento da potência para a sua atualização (a estrutura real do ser).

- Livro para citar:

  Aquinas: A Beginner's Guide (Capítulo 2: Metaphysics — seções sobre Ato/Potência, Hilomorfismo e Causalidade).

  Scholastic Metaphysics (Capítulo 1: Act and Potency e Capítulo 4: Form and Matter).

5. Implicações Contemporâneas: A Finalidade na Ciência Contemporânea (~1 Página)

- Objetivo: Demonstrar que o realismo da finalidade de Feser se aplica à física e biologia modernas (não sendo "física pré-moderna caduca").
- Pontos a desenvolver:
  Leis da física como disposições/potências reais (propriedades intencionais do mundo físico).

A irredutibilidade dos organismos vivos e processos biológicos em relação ao puro mecanicismo (o metabolismo e funções biológicas).

- Livro para citar:

Aristotle's Revenge (Capítulo 3: Matter, Form, and Change e Capítulo 6: Teleology).

"Alternatively, it might be thought of as the most philosophical end of natural science – natural science as it begins to stretch beyond what can be tested via observation and experiment and relies more on a priori considerations. As we will see, much work in contemporary analytic philosophy going under the "metaphysics" label in fact recapitulates traditional themes in the philosophy of nature. We will also see that many claims today put forward as "scientific" are in fact philosophical, or a mixture of the philosophical and the empirical. Nor are such confusions uniquely modern. Aristotle's Physics was as much a work of philosophy of nature as a work of physics, and the fact that there was no distinction drawn between these fields of study in Aristotle's day or for centuries thereafter led many erroneously to throw the Aristotelian philosophy of nature baby out with the Aristotelian physics bathwater. Precisely because of such errors, however, it is crucial to emphasize the difference in principle between the disciplines, occasional overlap notwithstanding." P. 5

6. Conclusão (~0,5 a 1 Página)

- Objetivo: Sintetizar os achados do paper.
- Pontos a desenvolver:

Recapitulação: A finalidade em Feser não é um adendo teológico ou ilusão psicológica, mas o alicerce ontológico indispensável do realismo metafísico.

Afirmação final: Negar o realismo do princípio de finalidade resulta na destruição da própria inteligibilidade do mundo natural e do método científico.